

STOPTIGRE project: community engagement using art and science transdisciplinary approach



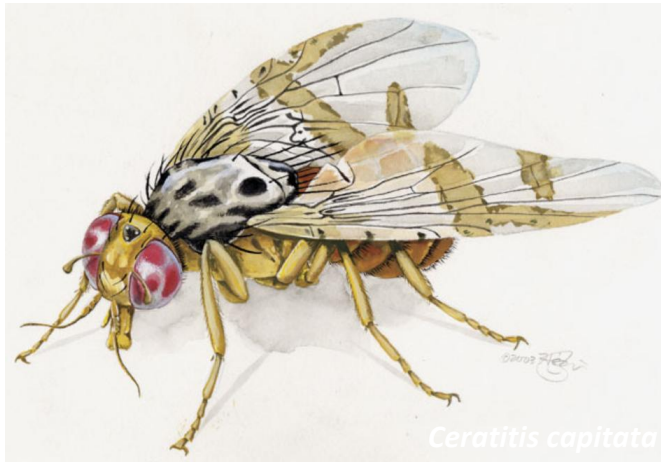


Sex determination in insects

SEX DETERMINATION

Maleness-on-the-Y (MoY) orchestrates male sex determination in major agricultural fruit fly pests

Angela Meccariello^{1*}, Marco Salvemini^{1*}, Pasquale Primo¹, Brantley Hall², Panagiota Koskinioti^{3,4}, Martina Daliková^{5,6}, Andrea Gravina¹, Michela Anna Gucciardino¹, Federica Forlenza¹, Maria-Eleni Gregoriou⁴, Domenica Ippolito¹, Simona Maria Monti⁷, Valeria Petrella¹, Maryanna Martina Perrotta¹, Stephan Schmeing⁸, Alessia Ruggiero⁷, Francesca Scolari⁹, Ennio Giordano¹, Konstantina T. Tsoumani⁴, František Mareš⁵, Nikolai Windbichler¹⁰, Kallare P. Arunkumar¹¹, Kostas Bourtzis³, Kostas D. Mathiopoulos⁴, Giannis Ragoussis¹², Luigi Vitagliano⁷, Zhijian Tu², Philippos Aris Papathanos^{13,14†}, Mark D. Robinson^{8†}, Giuseppe Saccone^{1†}



Ceratitis capitata

Meccariello et al., *Science* **365**, 1457–1460 (2019) 27 September 2019

Salvemini et al. *BMC Evolutionary Biology* 2011, **11**:41
<http://www.biomedcentral.com/1471-2148/11/41>



RESEARCH ARTICLE

Open Access

Genomic organization and splicing evolution of the *doublesex* gene, a *Drosophila* regulator of sexual differentiation, in the dengue and yellow fever mosquito *Aedes aegypti*

Marco Salvemini^{1†}, Umberto Mauro^{1,2†}, Fabrizio Lombardo³, Andreina Milano¹, Vincenzo Zazzaro¹, Bruno Arcà^{3,4}, Lino C. Polito^{1,5}, Giuseppe Saccone^{1*}

OPEN ACCESS Freely available online



The Orthologue of the Fruitfly Sex Behaviour Gene *Fruitless* in the Mosquito *Aedes aegypti*: Evolution of Genomic Organisation and Alternative Splicing

Marco Salvemini^{1*}, Rocco D'Amato¹, Valeria Petrella¹, Serena Aceto¹, Derric Nimmo², Marco Neira², Luke Alphey^{2,3}, Lino C. Polito¹, Giuseppe Saccone¹

¹ Department of Biological Sciences – Section of Genetics and Molecular Biology, University of Naples “Federico II”, Naples, Italy, ² Oxitec Limited, Oxford, United Kingdom, ³ Department of Zoology, University of Oxford, Oxford, United Kingdom



Department of
Biology
University of
Naples Federico
II



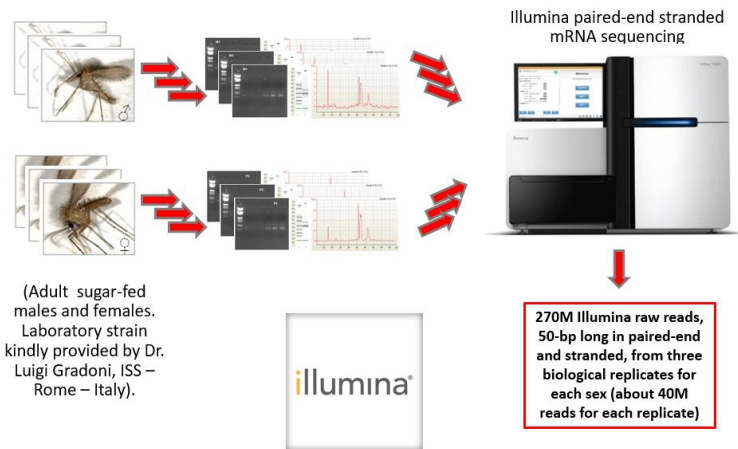
2014



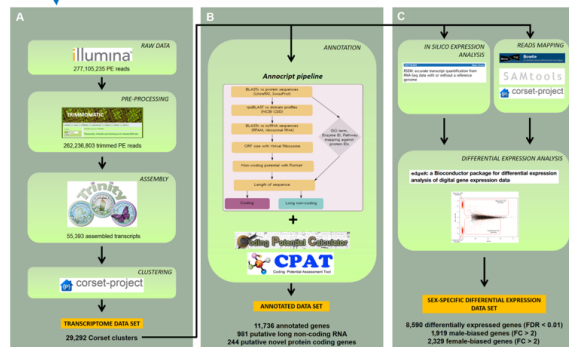
Serena Aceto



Vincenza Colonna



270M Illumina raw reads, 50-bp long in paired-end and stranded, from three biological replicates for each sex



Sex determination in insects

Petrella et al. BMC Genomics (2015) 16:847
DOI 10.1186/s12864-015-2088-x



RESEARCH ARTICLE

Open Access



De novo assembly and sex-specific transcriptome profiling in the sand fly *Phlebotomus perniciosus* (Diptera, Phlebotominae), a major Old World vector of *Leishmania infantum*

V. Petrella¹, S. Aceto¹, F. Musacchia², V. Colonna³, M. Robinson^{4,5}, V. Benes⁶, G. Cicotti⁷, G. Bongiorno⁸, L. Gradoni⁸, P. Volf⁹ and M. Salvemini^{1*}

Petrella et al. BMC Genomics (2019) 20:522
<https://doi.org/10.1186/s12864-019-5898-4>

BMC Genomics

RESEARCH ARTICLE

Open Access



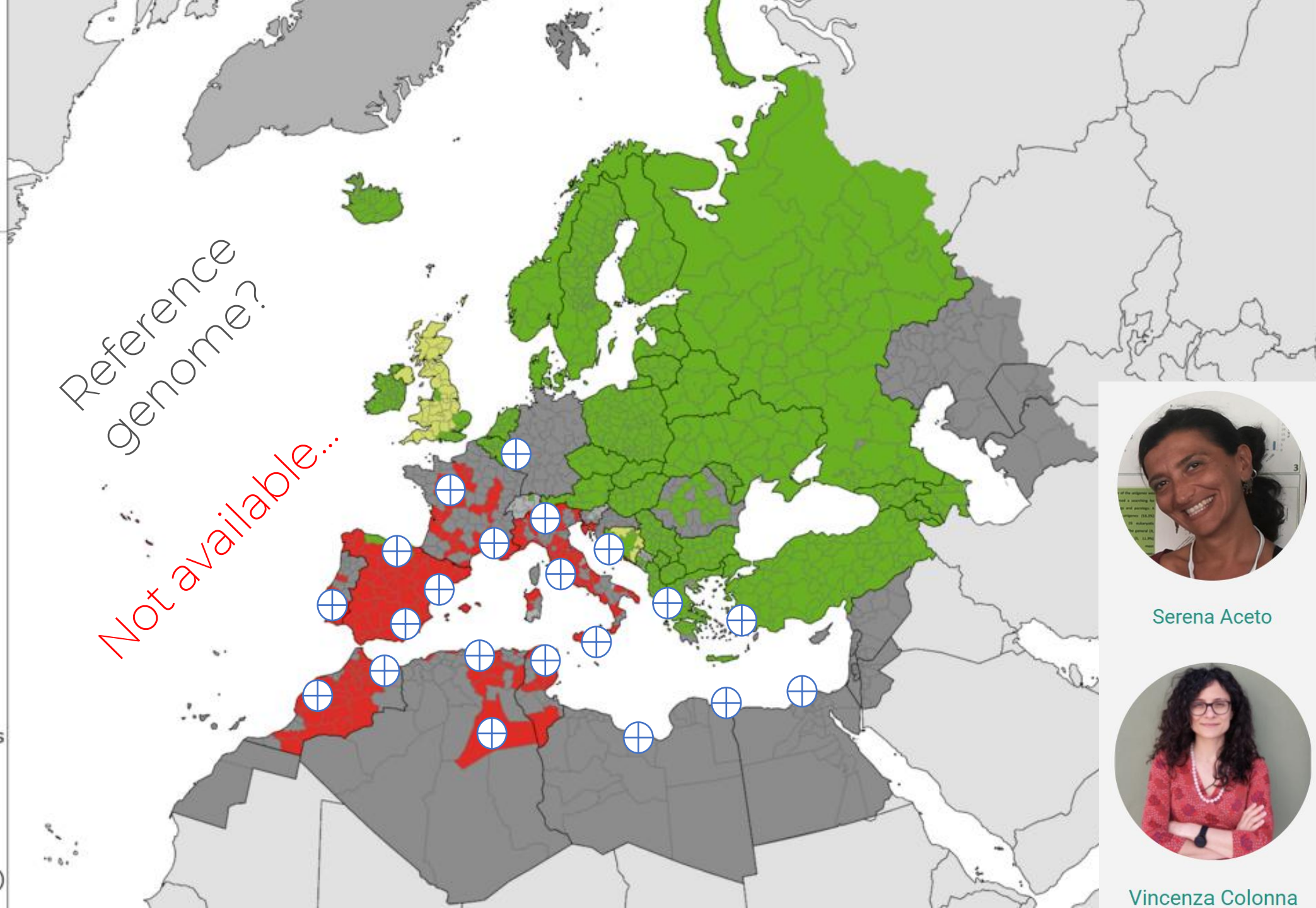
Identification of sex determination genes and their evolution in Phlebotominae sand flies (Diptera, Nematocera)

Valeria Petrella¹, Serena Aceto¹, Vincenza Colonna², Giuseppe Saccone¹, Remo Sanges^{3,4}, Nikola Polanska⁵, Petr Volf⁶, Luigi Gradoni⁶, Gioia Bongiorno⁶ and Marco Salvemini^{1*}

- Present
- Introduced
- Antic. Absent
- Obs. Absent
- No data
- Unknown

Countries/Regions not viewable in the main map extent*

- Malta
- Monaco
- San Marino
- Gibraltar
- Liechtenstein
- Azores (PT)
- Canary Islands (ES)
- Madeira (PT)
- Jan Mayen (NO)



Serena Aceto

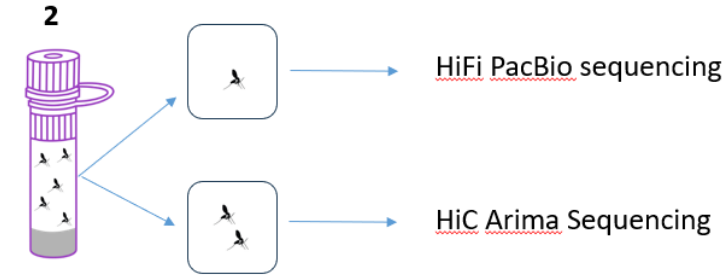


Vincenza Colonna

Primary assembly 2026

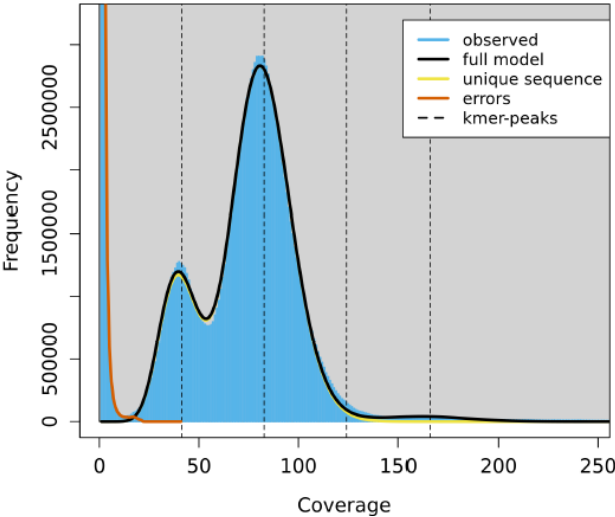
The sandfly *P. perniciosus* genome project: 2nd attempt with 1 individual

90ng di HMW gDNA extracted. High quality Pac-Bio genome sequencing for *P. perniciosus* resulting in ~67x HiFi coverage (12,0 Gb HiFi reads with an average length of 9,000 bp).



GenomeScope Profile

len:143,717,092bp uniq:80.9%
aa:99.4% ab:0.641%
kcov:41.4 err:0.0703% dup:1.52 k:21 p:2



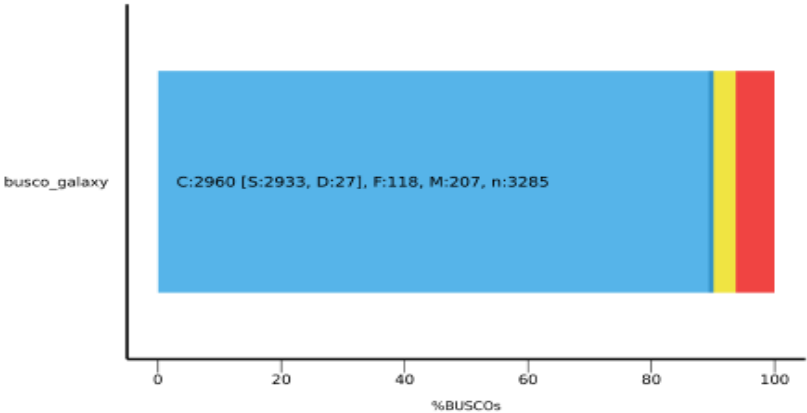
S1 Primary

Expected genome size	143,801,699
# scaffolds	21
Total scaffold length	150,235,544
Average scaffold length	7,154,073.52
Scaffold N50	36,611,036
Scaffold auN	33,592,830.57
Scaffold L50	2
Scaffold NG50	36,611,036
Scaffold auNG	35,095,810.48
Scaffold LG50	2
Largest scaffold	45,557,476
Smallest scaffold	11,360

N50 - L50

BUSCO Assessment Results

Complete (C) and single-copy (S) Complete (C) and duplicated (D)
Fragmented (F) Missing (M)



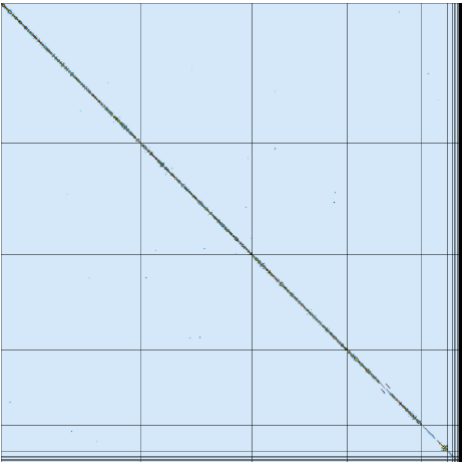
1 individual



In collaboration with:



Giulio Formenti



HiC scaffolding

2016

<https://stoptigre.evosexdevo.eu/>

Citizen-science Research

Third mission



STOPTIGRE
Citizen-science | Ricerca | Terza Missione

Mosquitoes
are considered
the world's
deadliest
animal species



100 Elephant



World's
deadliest
Animals

Number of humans
killed by animals,
2015



8,000 kissing bug



4,400 Fresh water snail



1,600 Tapeworm



24,200 Sandfly



830,000 Mosquitoes



500 Hippopotamus



3,500 Scorpion



6 Shark



17,400 Dog



40 Jellyfish



60 Bee



60,000 Snake



3,500 Tsetse fly



SOURCES: IHME, WHO, CrocBITE, FAO, Norwegian Institute for Nature Research, International Shark Attack File, National Geographic, PBS, National Science Foundation, CDC, WWF, French Institute of Research for Development, Wilderness & Environmental Medicine, Nature. All calculations have wide error margins.

Fighting insect pests
with pesticides: a
blessing and curse
approach





**Food and Agriculture Organization
of the United Nations**

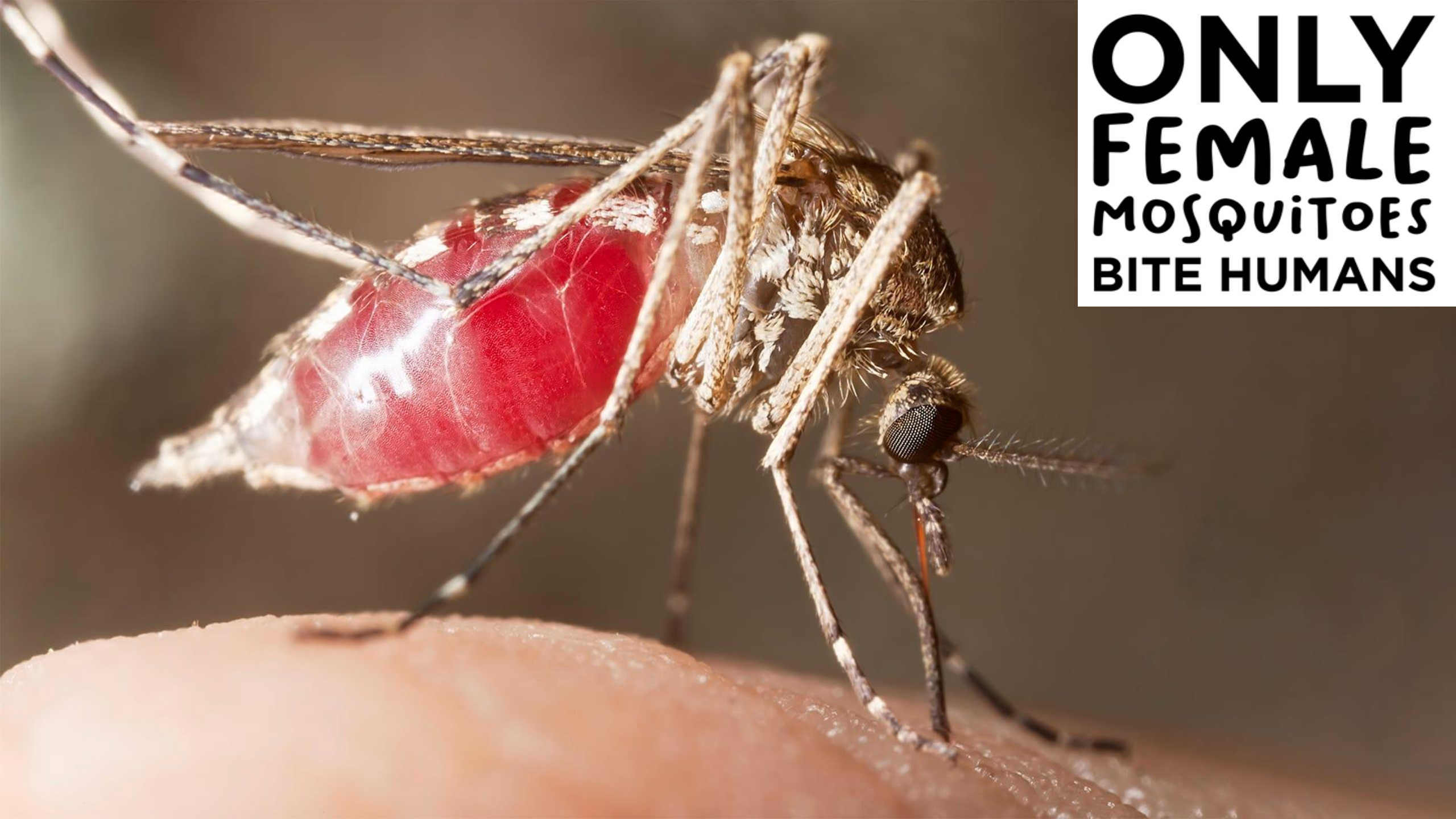


IAEA

International Atomic Energy Agency

Atoms for Peace

**ONLY
FEMALE
MOSQUITOES
BITE HUMANS**



MAJOR SHORTCOMINGS THAT LIMIT SIT/IIT APPLICATION TO MOSQUITOES ON A LARGE SCALE



1) Absence of an efficient sex separation technology

No 100% efficient sex sorting system available to date at an industrial scale.



Female pupae

Male pupae

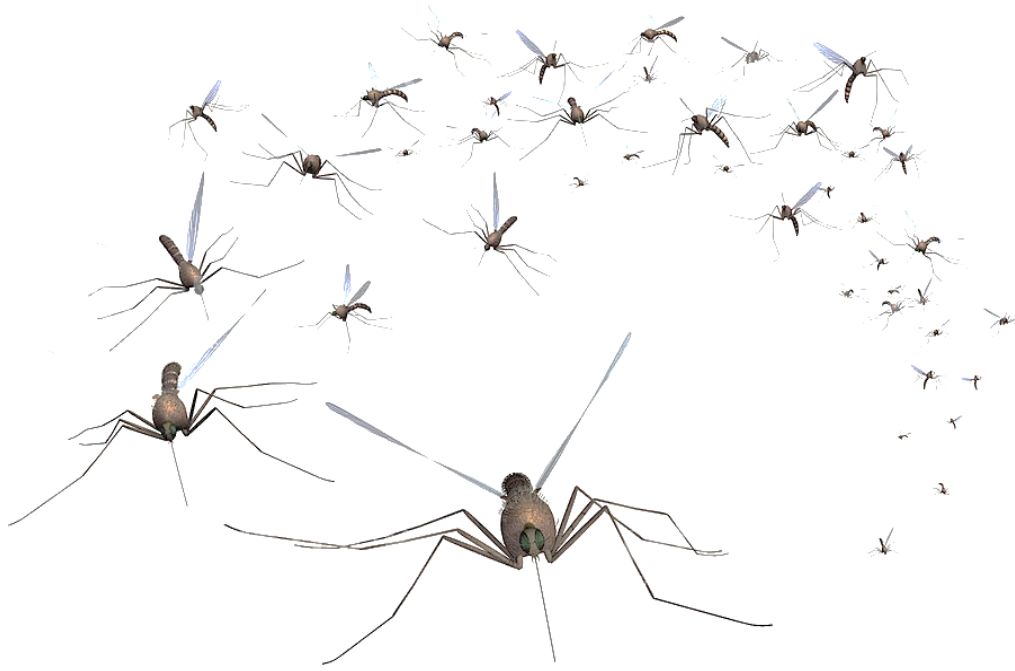
Larvae



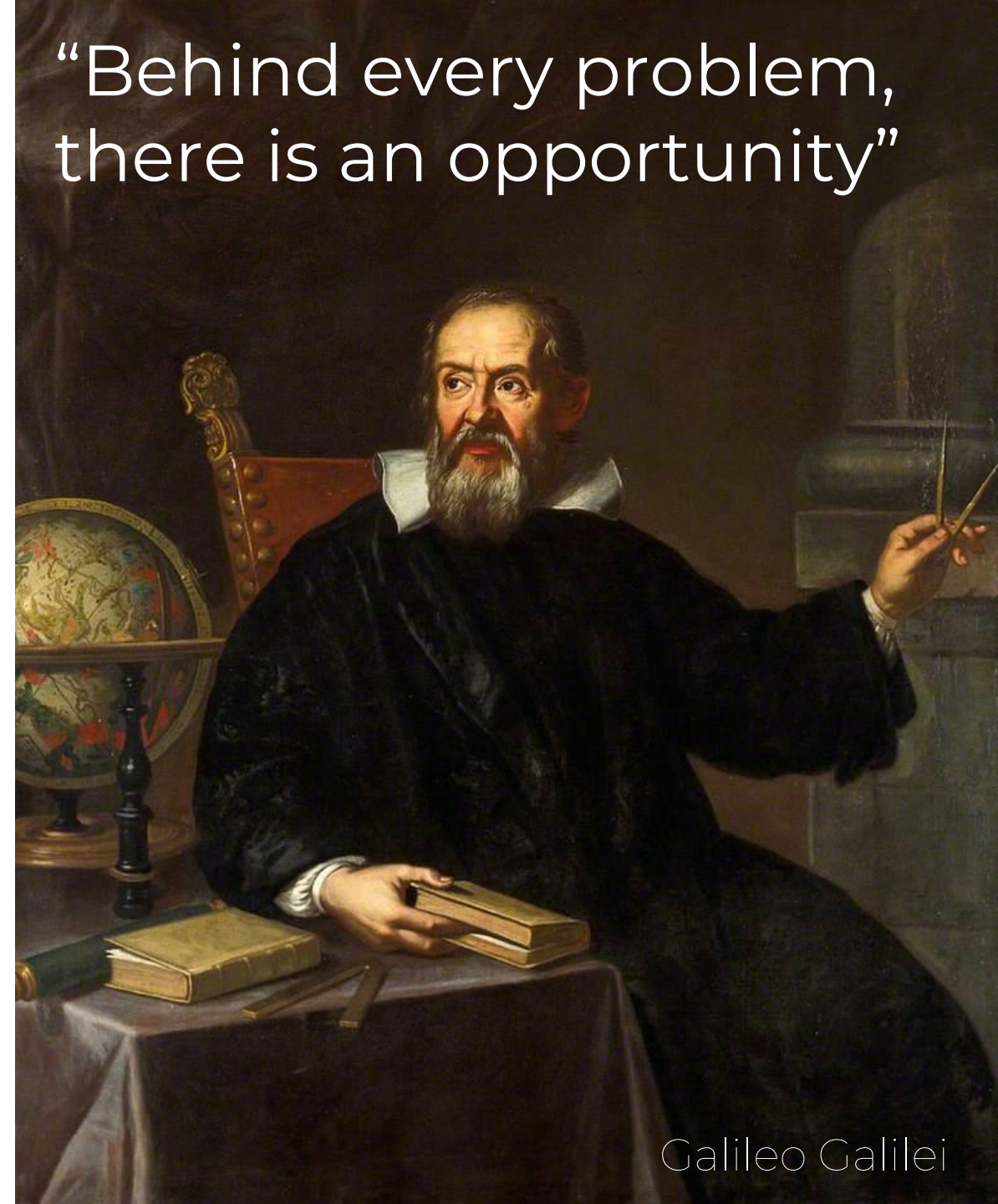
MAJOR SHORTCOMINGS THAT LIMIT SIT/IIT APPLICATION TO MOSQUITOES ON A LARGE SCALE

2) Without effective community participation, eco-friendly control campaigns could not be achieved





“Behind every problem,
there is an opportunity”



Galileo Galilei



Ecofriendly tiger mosquito suppression on Procida Island through community participation



Ph: Roberto Savio 04/2018



Raimondo Ambrosino,
Procida **Mayor**

Rossella Lauro,
counselor

Giuseppe
Saccone

Titta Lubrano,
counselor

Vincenza Colonna
IBG-CNR



Promotion of scientific culture on the Island by organizing scientific events



2019



2023

PROCIDA
SCIENCE
ISLAND



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT WITH THE HELP OF THE PROCIDA ADMINISTRATION

2016

Temporal dynamics
analysis over one year
using ovitraps involving
12 volunteers

RAIMONDO AMBROSINO
PROCIDA MAYOR

ROSSELLA LAURO
MUNICIPAL CONSELOR

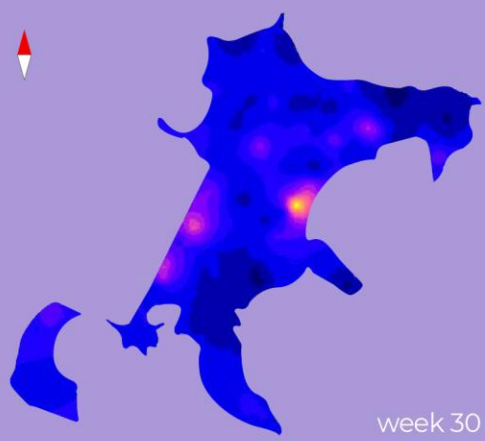
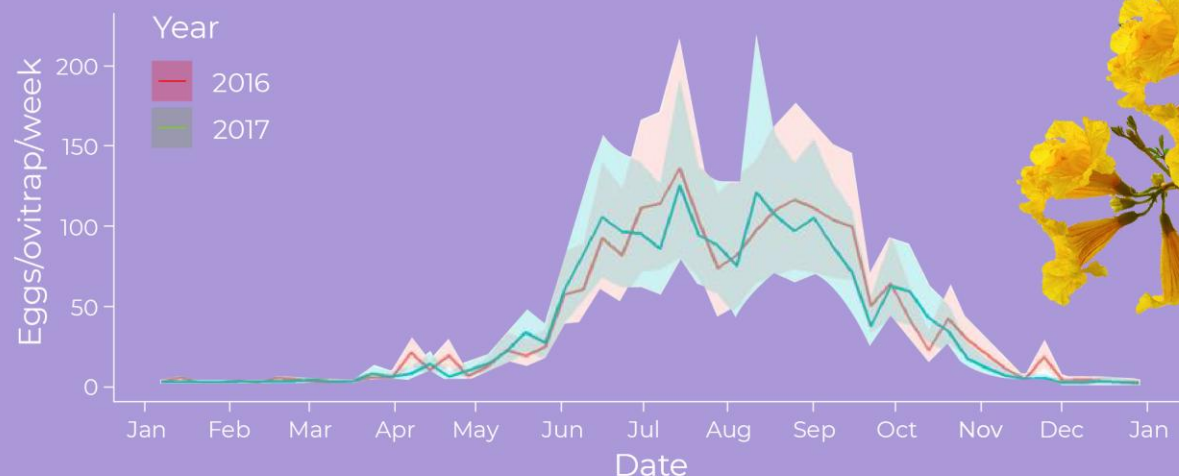


2016





With the active participation of Citizen, we collected baseline data about *Aedes albopictus* bionomics on Procida Island



PLOS NEGLECTED TROPICAL DISEASES

RESEARCH ARTICLE

Aedes albopictus bionomics data collection by citizen participation on Procida Island, a promising Mediterranean site for the assessment of innovative and community-based integrated pest management methods

Beniamino Caputo¹, Giuliano Langella², Valeria Petrella³, Chiara Virgillito^{1,4}, Mattia Manica^{5,6}, Federico Filippini^{7,8}, Marianna Varone⁹, Pasquale Primo³, Arianna Puggioli⁷, Romeo Bellini⁷, Costantino D'Antonio⁸, Luca Iesu³, Liliana Tullo³, Ciro Rizzo³, Annalisa Longobardi³, Germano Sollazzo³, Maryanna Martina Perrotta³, Miriana Fabozzi³, Fabiana Palmieri³, Giuseppe Saccone³, Roberto Rosà^{4,9}, Alessandra della Torre¹, Marco Salvemini^{3*}

1 Department of Public Health and Infectious Diseases, University of Rome La Sapienza, Rome, Italy, 2 Department of Agriculture, University of Naples Federico II, Naples, Italy, 3 Department of Biology, University of Naples Federico II, Naples, Italy, 4 Department of Biodiversity and Molecular Ecology, Edmund Mach Foundation, San Michele all'Adige, Italy, 5 Center for Health Emergencies, Bruno Kessler Foundation, Trento, Italy, 6 Istituto Superiore per la Protezione e la Ricerca Ambientale, Rome, Italy, 7 Centro Agricoltura Ambiente "Giorgio Nicosi", Crevalcore, Italy, 8 Ministry of Education, University and Research, Rome, Italy, 9 Centre Agriculture Food Environment, University of Trento, San Michele all'Adige (TN), Italy

* marco.salvemini@uniroma2.it

Abstract

In the last decades, the colonization of Mediterranean Europe and of other temperate regions by *Aedes albopictus* created an unprecedented nuisance problem in highly infested areas and new public health threats due to the vector competence of the species. The Ster-



OPEN ACCESS

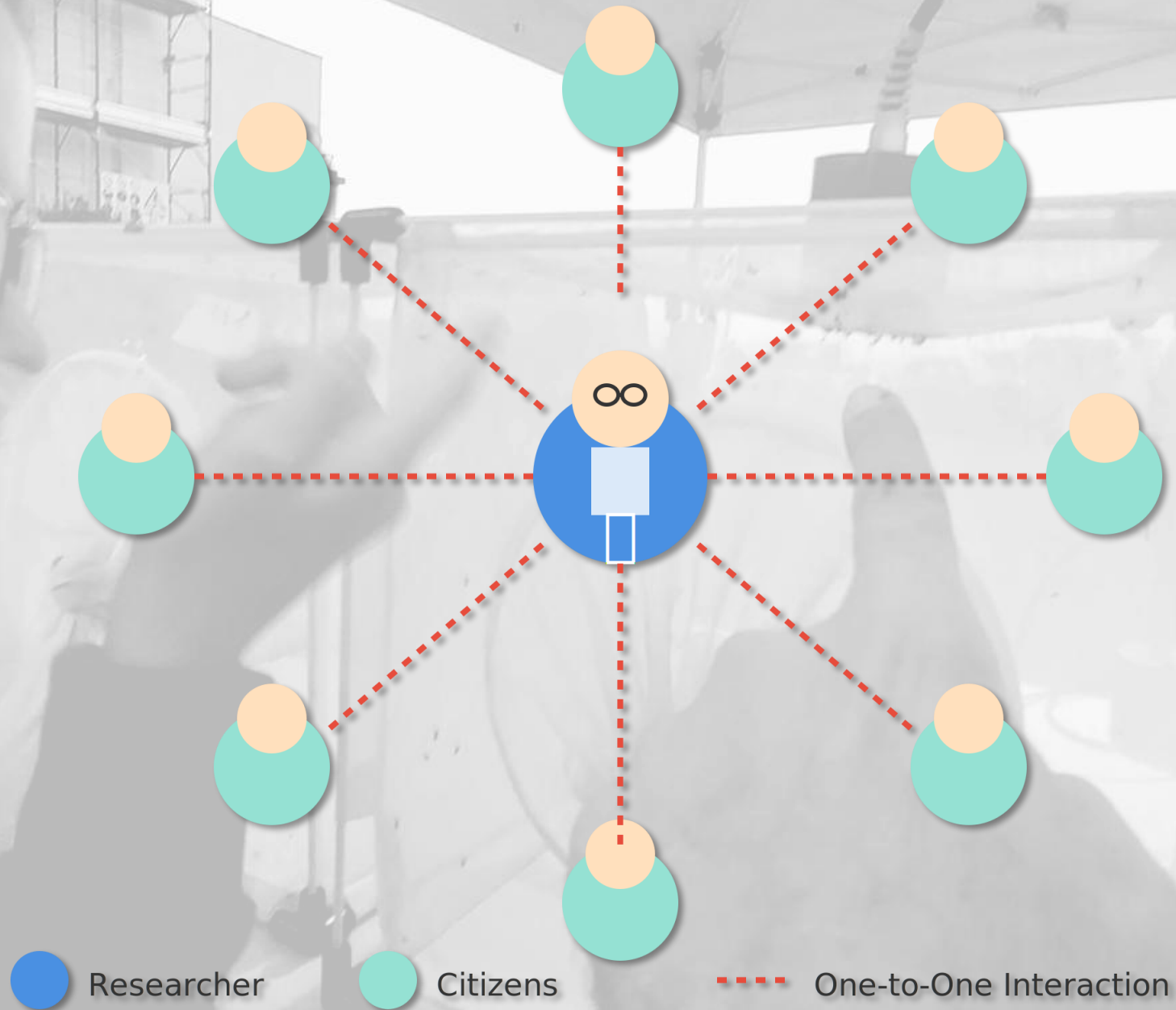
Citation: Caputo B, Langella G, Petrella V, Virgillito C, Manica M, Filippini F, et al. (2021) *Aedes albopictus* bionomics data collection by citizen participation on Procida Island, a promising Mediterranean site for the assessment of innovative and community-based integrated pest management methods. PLoS Negl Trop Dis 15(9): e0008698. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pntd.0008698>

MEETMETONIGHT

2018 – 2019 – 2020 – 2021



Researcher-Centered Approach





**THE POWER
OF
RELATIONSHIPS**

COMMUNITY
ENGAGEMENT...
HOW to involve
a whole
community
instead of
hundreds of
citizens???



2019

HOW WE MET

SCIENCE

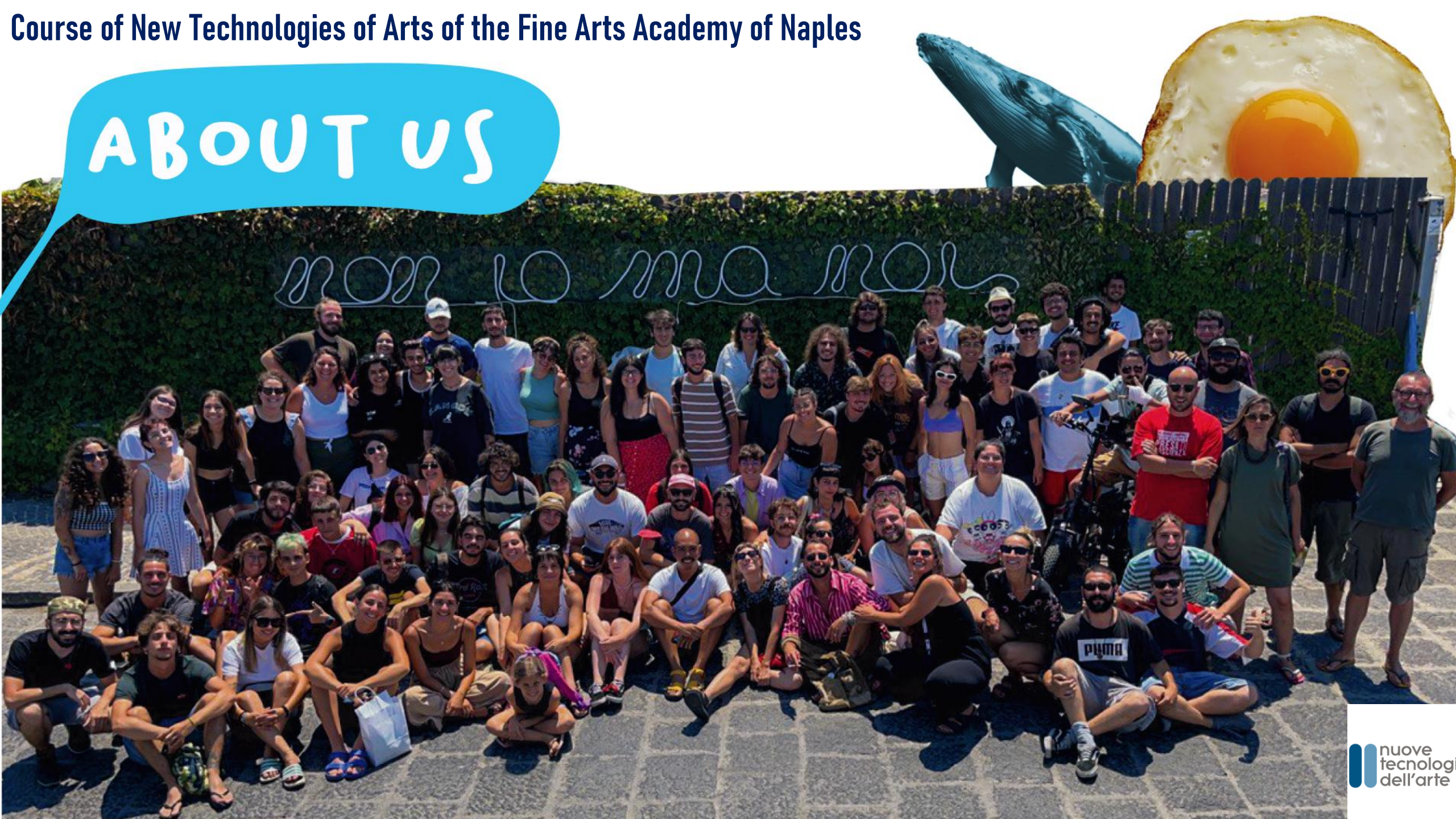
ART

nuove
tecnologie
dell'arte

TEDx



ABOUT US



The French curator Nicolas Bourriaud published a book called *Relational Aesthetics* in 1998 in which he defined the term as:

A set of artistic practices which take as their theoretical and practical point of departure the whole of human relations and their social context, rather than an independent and private space

He saw artists as facilitators rather than makers and regarded art as information exchanged between the artist and the viewers. The artist, in this sense, gives audiences access to power and the means to change the world.

In relational art, the audience is envisaged as a community. Rather than the artwork being an encounter between a viewer and an object, relational art produces encounters between people. Through these encounters, meaning is elaborated *collectively*, rather than in the space of individual consumption.

Bourriaud, Nicolas (2002). *Relational Aesthetics*. Pp.17-18.

ART TERM

RELATIONAL AESTHETICS

Term created by curator Nicolas Bourriaud in the 1990s to describe the tendency to make art based on, or inspired by, human relations and their social context



<https://www.tate.org.uk/art/art-terms/r/relational-aesthetics>

TIGER MOSQUITO

Monitoring and control campaign



A socio-cultural event focused on the fight against mosquitoes which, at the same time, could nourish the sense of **COMMUNITY** and of **CARE** for the territory.



 nuove
tecnologie
dell'arte



Relational accelerator devices



(GIFT)

DONO



PHASE 1

PHASE 1

MURO

(WALL)



PHASE 2



PHASE 2

PHASE 2

MAY

3D CENSUS





PHASE 2

3D CENSUS OF PROCIDA POPULATION

[HOME](#)[CHI SIAMO](#)[MANIFESTO](#)[PROGETTI](#)[BLOG](#)[PATTO FORMATIVO](#)[STATO DELL'ARTE](#)[CONTATTACI](#)

Censimento 3D

Per Procida Capitale Italiana della Cultura 2022



PHASE 2



PHASE 2

(Artwork-EVENT)

OPERA *evento*

A decorative graphic featuring a string of teal bunting flags draped across the word 'OPERA'. A horizontal teal line extends from the right side of the word 'evento' across the page.

[A public event, co-organized with citizens, defined as "relational anthropological sculpture". A shared moment during which the relationships built during the project become the raw "material itself" by which the artwork-event is composed]

PHASE 3



**STOP
TO
GRE**



PHASE 2.1



ABBIAMO
POSIZIONATO
500
GRAVITRAPPOLE

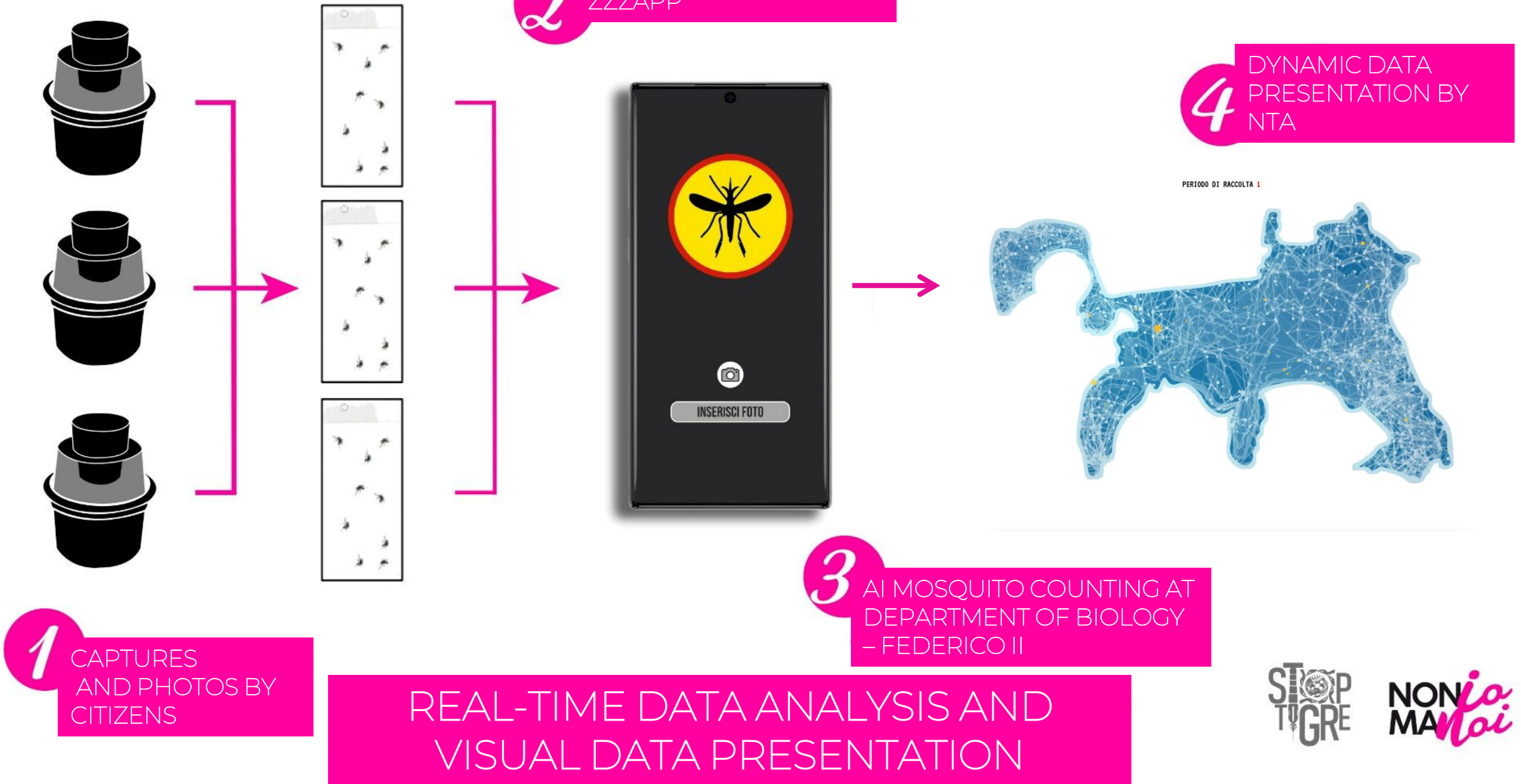
PROCIDA
2022



In just 5
days!!!



PHASE 2.1



2024



**nuove
tecnologie
dell'arte**

**STOP
TO
GRE**

**NOI
UMANI**

POWERED BY
ATTO D'AMORE



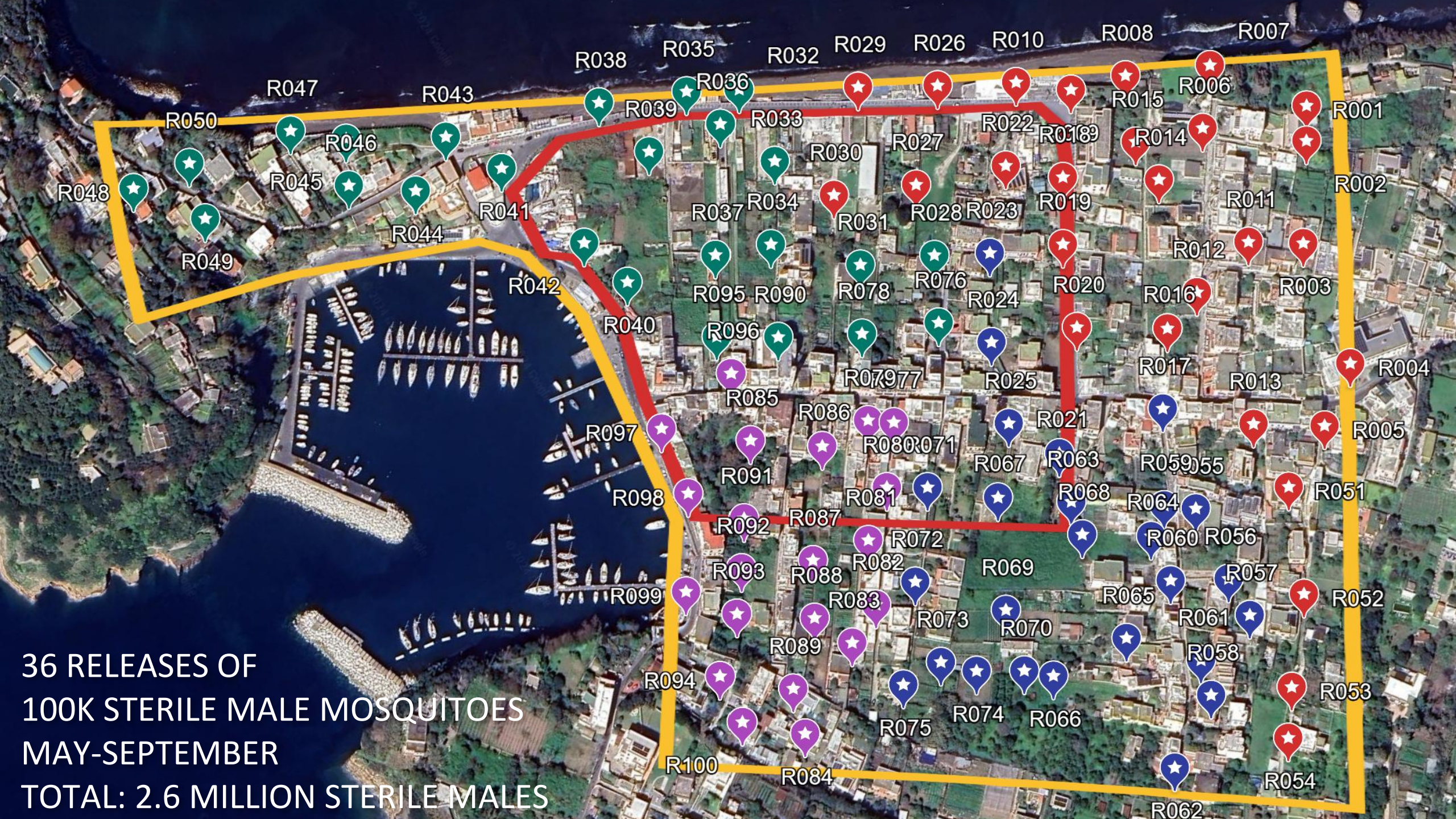
**Finanziato
dall'Unione europea**
NextGenerationEU

TEST
AREA



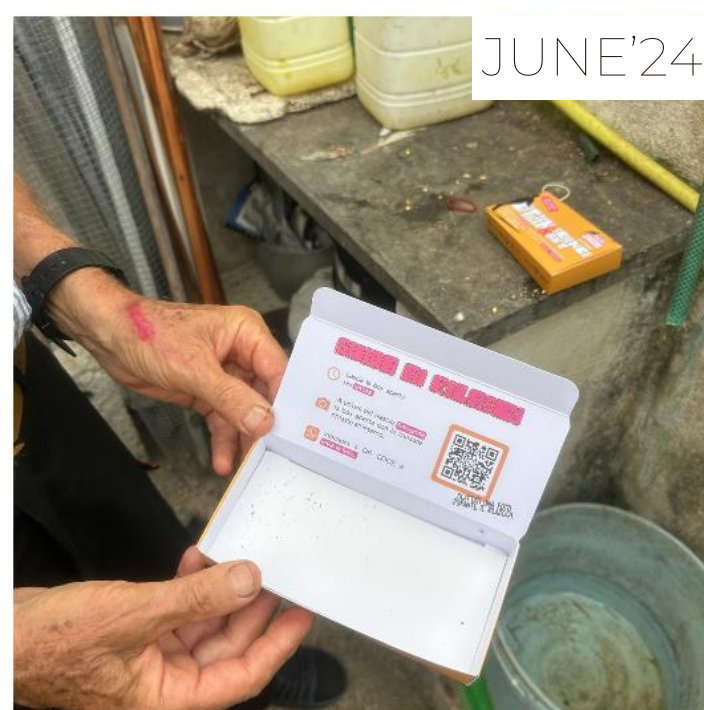
CONTROL
AREA





36 RELEASES OF
100K STERILE MALE MOSQUITOES
MAY-SEPTEMBER
TOTAL: 2.6 MILLION STERILE MALES

JUNE'24



JULY'24



Citizen
releases

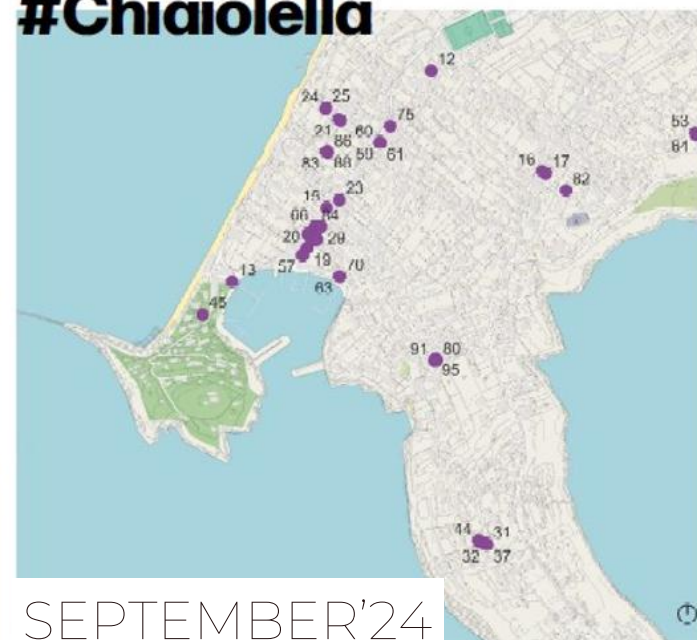
120,000
sterile
males
distributed
over four
months

89 families
involved

AUGUST'24



#Chiaiolella



SEPTEMBER'24



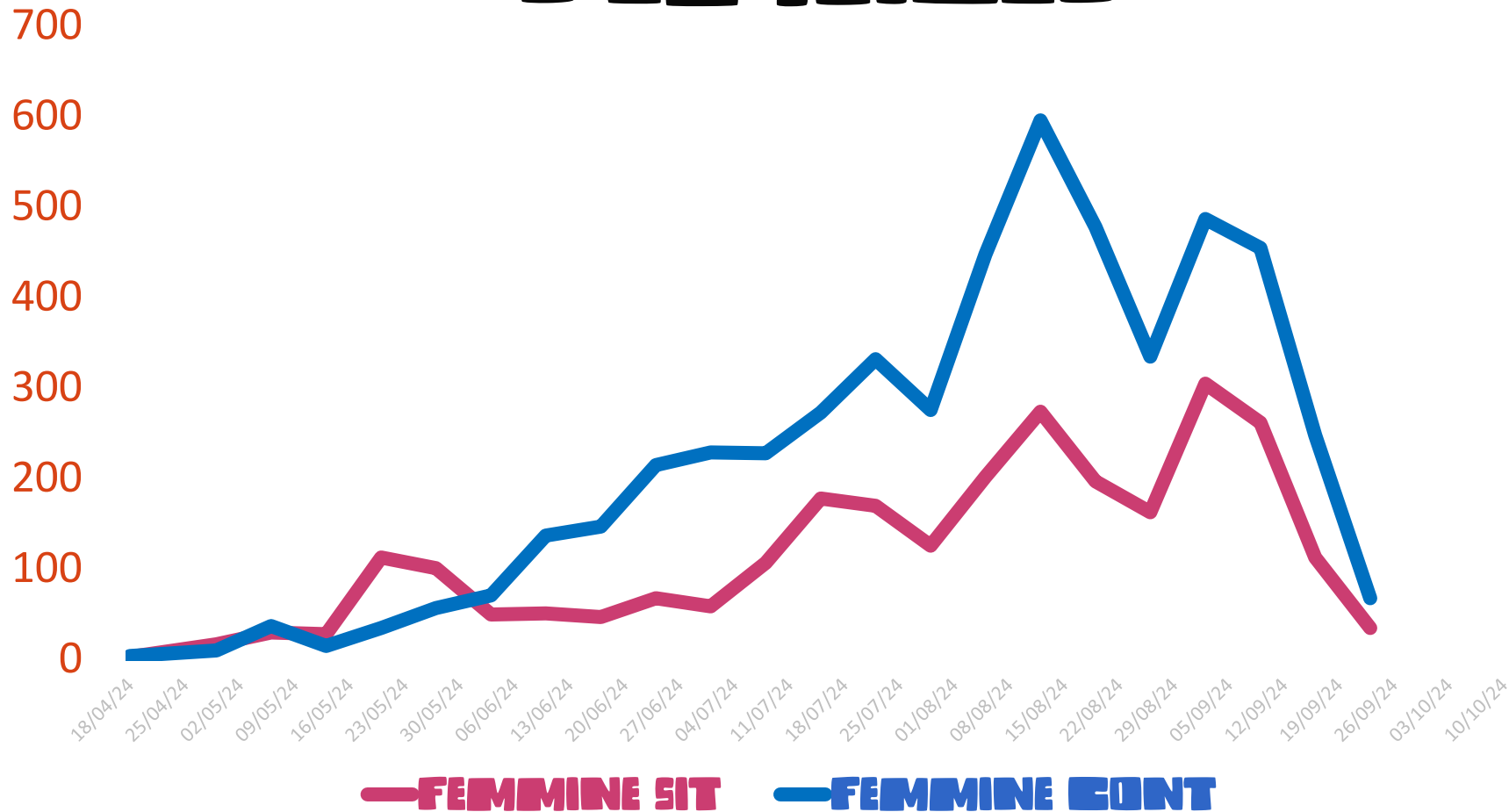


IMPACT?



TOTAL GRAVID FEMALES

**REDUCTION IN THE
POPULATION OF
PREGNANT FEMALES
OF TIGER MOSQUITO**



-55%

**IN THE TEST AREA
WITH RESPECT TO
THE CONTROL
AREA**

(CAUGHT WITH GRAVID TRAPS)



WHAT'S NEXT?

TEST
ISLAND!!



The Procida
case study

il CASO PROCIDA



THINK GLOBAL , ACT LOCAL

Gennaro
Volpe
(Saccone
lab)

Marianna
Varone

Maria
Giovanna
Matrone

Dora
Baccaro

Francesca
Lucibelli

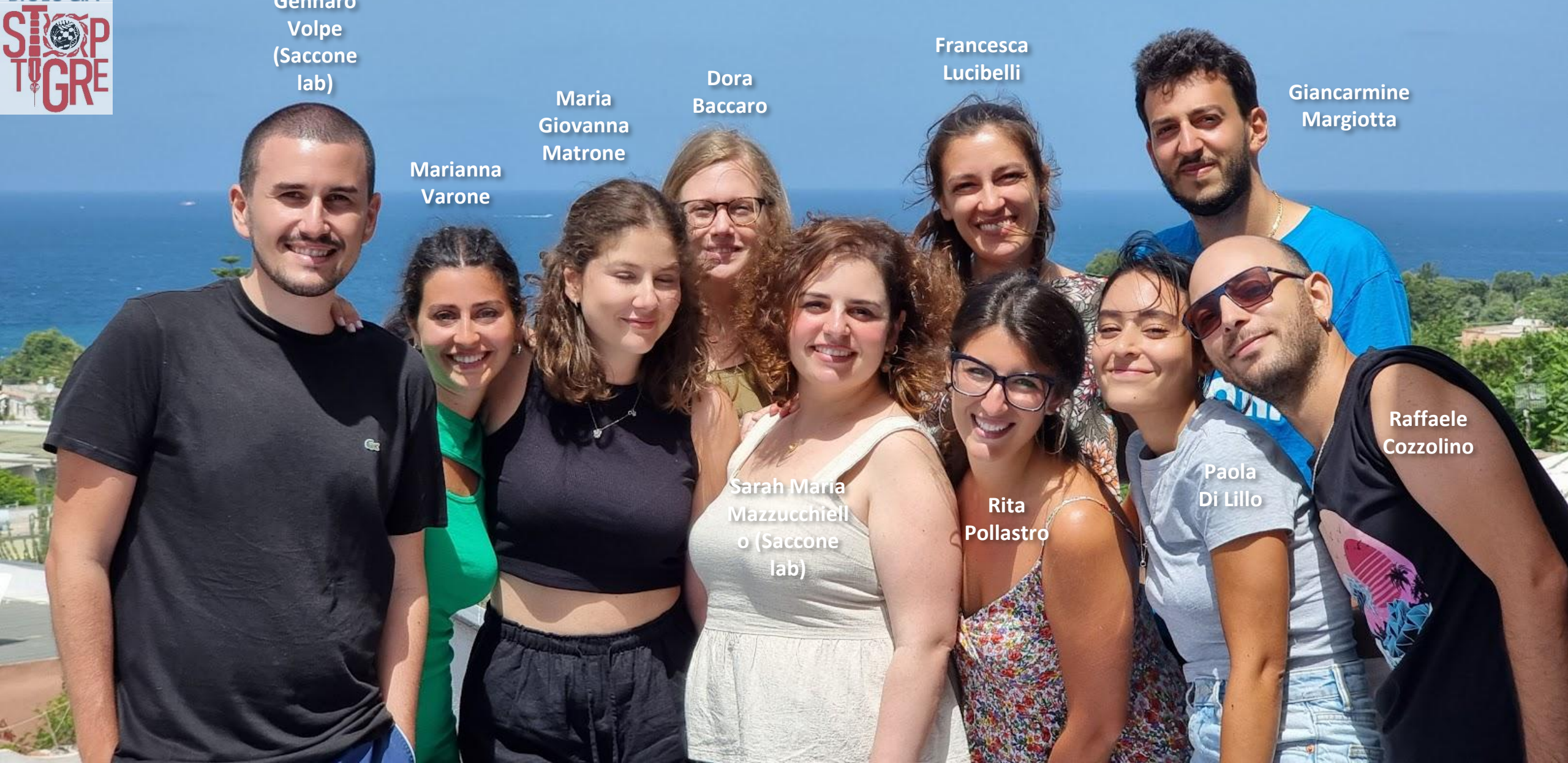
Giancarmine
Margiotta

Sarah Maria
Mazzucchiello
(Saccone
lab)

Rita
Pollastro

Paola
Di Lillo

Raffaele
Cozzolino



THANK YOU!

